Serials

H 178

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A. Background

This instruction sheet provides Library of Congress catalogers with policy guidelines for assigning subject headings to serials.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

For guidelines on electronic serials, see H 1580.5. For guidelines on indexes to periodicals, see H 1670. For guidelines on newspapers on special topics and newspapers of ethnic groups in the United States, see H 1920. For classification of periodicals, see F 210 and F 220.

B. Recent revisions

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. General rule

Assign a full set of subject headings in accordance with normal guidelines. Choose headings that characterize the scope and intent of the serial as a whole, not headings that would be appropriate only for the content of the specific issue(s) at hand.

D. Serials linked to previously cataloged serials

Assign appropriate and valid subject headings without regard to the headings assigned to previously cataloged serials that are linked to the new serial, even if the numbering continues

from one to another. The subject headings that were assigned to the previously cataloged serial may be corrected or updated, if necessary, but the headings assigned to the earlier and later serials need not be exactly the same.

E. The subdivision --Periodicals

Use the form subdivision ***--Periodicals*** according to the guidelines provided in H 1927.

LC practice: Assign LCGFT to bring out the genre and/or form of the resource being cataloged, e.g., ***Periodicals***.

Revision history

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.